Microsoft Word

Keyboard Shortcuts - Complete Reference

For Word on Windows (Word 2016, 2019, 2021 and Microsoft 365). "Ctrl + C" means hold Ctrl, then press C. On a Mac, most shortcuts use the Command key instead of Ctrl.

1. Most Used Shortcuts

Ctrl + C	Copy
Ctrl + X	Cut
Ctrl + V	Paste
Ctrl + Z	Undo
Ctrl + Y	Redo / repeat last action
Ctrl + A	Select all
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + P	Print
Ctrl + B	Bold
Ctrl + I	Italic
Ctrl + U	Underline
Ctrl + F	Find
Ctrl + H	Find and replace
Ctrl + N	New blank document
Ctrl + O	Open a document

2. File and Document

Ctrl + N	Create a new blank document
Ctrl + O or Ctrl + F12	Open a document
Ctrl + S or Shift + F12	Save the document
F12	Save As
Ctrl + P or Ctrl + Shift + F12	Print (opens the Print screen)
Ctrl + F2	Print preview
Ctrl + W or Ctrl + F4	Close the current document
Alt + F4	Close Word (exit the program)
Ctrl + F6	Switch to the next open document window
Ctrl + Shift + F6	Switch to the previous open document window
Ctrl + F10	Maximize or restore the document window
Ctrl + Alt + S	Split the window or remove the split
Alt + Tab	Switch to another open program

F1	Open Word Help
Esc	Cancel the current command or dialog
Ctrl + F1	Show or hide the ribbon

3. Moving Around (Navigation)

Left / Right Arrow	Move one character left or right
Up / Down Arrow	Move one line up or down
Ctrl + Left / Right Arrow	Move one word left or right
Ctrl + Up / Down Arrow	Move one paragraph up or down
Home	Go to the start of the line
End	Go to the end of the line
Ctrl + Home	Go to the start of the document
Ctrl + End	Go to the end of the document
Page Up / Page Down	Scroll one screen up or down
Ctrl + Page Up / Page Down	Go to the previous / next page (browse object)
Alt + Ctrl + Page Up / Page Down	Go to the top / bottom of the visible window
Ctrl + G or F5	Open the Go To dialog (page, line, bookmark...)
Shift + F5	Return to the previous editing location
Alt + Ctrl + Home	Choose what to browse by (page, heading, table...)
Insert	Turn overtype mode on or off (if enabled)

4. Selecting Text

Ctrl + A	Select the whole document
Shift + Left / Right Arrow	Select one character at a time
Shift + Up / Down Arrow	Select one line up or down
Ctrl + Shift + Left / Right Arrow	Select one word at a time
Ctrl + Shift + Up / Down Arrow	Select to the start / end of the paragraph
Shift + Home	Select from the cursor to the start of the line
Shift + End	Select from the cursor to the end of the line
Ctrl + Shift + Home	Select from the cursor to the start of the document
Ctrl + Shift + End	Select from the cursor to the end of the document
Shift + Page Up / Page Down	Select one screen up or down
F8	Extend selection mode (press again: word, sentence, paragraph, document)
Shift + F8	Shrink the selection
Esc	Turn off extend selection mode

Ctrl + Shift + F8, then arrows	Select a rectangular block (column mode)
Alt + drag with mouse	Select a vertical block of text
Double-click	Select a word
Ctrl + click	Select a sentence
Triple-click	Select a paragraph

5. Editing Text

Ctrl + C	Copy the selection
Ctrl + X	Cut the selection
Ctrl + V	Paste
Ctrl + Alt + V	Paste Special
Ctrl + Shift + C	Copy formatting
Ctrl + Shift + V	Paste formatting
Ctrl + Z	Undo the last action
Ctrl + Y or F4	Redo / repeat the last action
Backspace	Delete one character to the left
Ctrl + Backspace	Delete one word to the left
Delete	Delete one character to the right
Ctrl + Delete	Delete one word to the right
Ctrl + F3	Cut the selection to the Spike
Ctrl + Shift + F3	Paste the contents of the Spike
F3	Insert an AutoText entry (after typing its name)
Alt + Shift + Up / Down Arrow	Move the selected paragraph up or down
Shift + F3	Change case (lowercase, UPPERCASE, Title Case)
Shift + F2	Copy text (then press Enter at the destination)
F2	Move text (then press Enter at the destination)

6. Character Formatting

Ctrl + B	Bold
Ctrl + I	Italic
Ctrl + U	Underline
Ctrl + Shift + W	Underline words only (not spaces)
Ctrl + Shift + D	Double underline
Ctrl + Shift + A	Make all capitals
Ctrl + Shift + K	Small capitals
Ctrl + Shift + H	Hidden text

Ctrl + =	Subscript
Ctrl + Shift + =	Superscript
Ctrl + D or Ctrl + Shift + F	Open the Font dialog
Ctrl + Shift + P	Jump to the Font Size box
Ctrl +]	Increase font size by 1 point
Ctrl + [	Decrease font size by 1 point
Ctrl + Shift + >	Increase font size to the next preset size
Ctrl + Shift + <	Decrease font size to the previous preset size
Ctrl + Spacebar	Remove manual character formatting
Ctrl + Shift + Q	Change the selection to the Symbol font
Shift + F1	Reveal formatting of the selected text

7. Paragraph Formatting and Styles

Ctrl + L	Align left
Ctrl + E	Center
Ctrl + R	Align right
Ctrl + J	Justify
Ctrl + M	Increase the left indent
Ctrl + Shift + M	Decrease the left indent
Ctrl + T	Create a hanging indent
Ctrl + Shift + T	Reduce a hanging indent
Ctrl + 1	Single line spacing
Ctrl + 5	1.5 line spacing
Ctrl + 2	Double line spacing
Ctrl + 0	Add or remove space before a paragraph
Ctrl + Q	Remove manual paragraph formatting
Ctrl + Shift + L	Apply the bulleted list style
Ctrl + Shift + N	Apply the Normal style
Alt + Ctrl + 1	Apply Heading 1
Alt + Ctrl + 2	Apply Heading 2
Alt + Ctrl + 3	Apply Heading 3
Ctrl + Shift + S	Jump to the Apply Styles box
Alt + Ctrl + Shift + S	Open the Styles pane
Tab / Shift + Tab	Demote / promote a list item (inside a list)

8. Find, Replace and Go To

Ctrl + F	Find (opens the Navigation pane)
Ctrl + H	Find and replace
Ctrl + G or F5	Go To a page, line, bookmark, etc.
Shift + F4 or Ctrl + Alt + Y	Repeat the last Find or Go To
Alt + Ctrl + Home	Select what to browse by

9. Inserting Items

Ctrl + Enter	Insert a page break
Ctrl + Shift + Enter	Insert a column break
Shift + Enter	Insert a line break (without starting a new paragraph)
Ctrl + Shift + Spacebar	Insert a non-breaking space
Ctrl + Shift + Hyphen	Insert a non-breaking hyphen
Ctrl + Hyphen	Insert an optional hyphen
Ctrl + K	Insert a hyperlink
Alt + =	Insert an equation
Alt + Shift + D	Insert the current date field
Alt + Shift + T	Insert the current time field
Alt + Shift + P	Insert a page number field
Ctrl + F9	Insert an empty field
Ctrl + Alt + F	Insert a footnote
Ctrl + Alt + D	Insert an endnote
Ctrl + Alt + M	Insert a comment
Ctrl + Alt + C	Insert the copyright symbol
Ctrl + Alt + R	Insert the registered trademark symbol
Ctrl + Alt + T	Insert the trademark symbol
Ctrl + Alt + . (period)	Insert an ellipsis
Unicode code, then Alt + X	Convert a typed Unicode hex code into its character

10. Tables

Tab	Move to the next cell (adds a new row in the last cell)
Shift + Tab	Move to the previous cell
Up / Down Arrow	Move to the row above / below
Alt + Home / Alt + End	Go to the first / last cell in the row
Alt + Page Up / Page Down	Go to the first / last cell in the column
Shift + Arrow keys	Select neighbouring cells

Alt + Shift + Up / Down Arrow	Move the current row up or down
Ctrl + Tab	Insert a tab character inside a cell
Alt + 5 (numeric keypad, Num Lock off)	Select the entire table

11. Review and Proofing

F7	Check spelling and grammar
Shift + F7	Open the Thesaurus
Ctrl + Shift + G	Open the Word Count dialog
Ctrl + Shift + E	Turn Track Changes on or off
Ctrl + Alt + M	Insert a comment
Shift + F10 or Menu key	Open the right-click (shortcut) menu

12. Views and Window

Ctrl + Alt + P	Print Layout view
Ctrl + Alt + O	Outline view
Ctrl + Alt + N	Draft view
Ctrl + Shift + 8	Show or hide formatting marks (paragraph marks, spaces)
Ctrl + Mouse wheel	Zoom in or out
F6	Move between the document, ribbon, task panes and status bar
Ctrl + F2	Print preview
Alt + F9	Show or hide all field codes

13. Fields

F9	Update the selected field(s)
Shift + F9	Switch between field code and field result
Alt + F9	Switch all fields between code and result
Ctrl + F9	Insert an empty field
Ctrl + Shift + F9	Unlink a field (convert to plain text)
F11	Go to the next field
Shift + F11	Go to the previous field
Ctrl + F11	Lock a field
Ctrl + Shift + F11	Unlock a field

14. Outline View

Alt + Shift + Left Arrow	Promote a paragraph (higher heading level)
Alt + Shift + Right Arrow	Demote a paragraph (lower heading level)
Ctrl + Shift + N	Demote to body text
Alt + Shift + Up / Down Arrow	Move the selected paragraphs up or down
Alt + Shift + + (plus)	Expand text under a heading
Alt + Shift + - (minus)	Collapse text under a heading
Alt + Shift + A	Expand or collapse all text and headings
Alt + Shift + 1 to 9	Show all headings up to the chosen level

15. Mail Merge (Legacy Shortcuts)

Alt + Shift + K	Preview the mail merge
Alt + Shift + N	Merge the document
Alt + Shift + M	Print the merged document
Alt + Shift + E	Edit the mail merge data
Alt + Shift + F	Insert a merge field

16. Ribbon Key Tips (press Alt, then the letter)

Alt, F	File menu (Backstage)
Alt, H	Home tab
Alt, N	Insert tab
Alt, G	Design tab
Alt, P	Layout tab
Alt, S	References tab
Alt, M	Mailings tab
Alt, R	Review tab
Alt, W	View tab
Alt, Q	Tell Me / Search box

17. Function Keys

F1	Help
Shift + F1	Reveal formatting
F2	Move text
Shift + F2	Copy text
F3	Insert AutoText entry
Shift + F3	Change case

Ctrl + F3	Cut to Spike
F4	Repeat last action
Shift + F4	Repeat Find / Go To
Ctrl + F4	Close window
Alt + F4	Exit Word
F5	Go To
Shift + F5	Previous editing location
F6	Next pane or frame
Shift + F6	Previous pane or frame
F7	Spelling and grammar
Shift + F7	Thesaurus
F8	Extend selection
Shift + F8	Shrink selection
F9	Update fields
Shift + F9	Toggle field code
Alt + F9	Toggle all field codes
F10	Show key tips
Shift + F10	Right-click menu
F11	Next field
Shift + F11	Previous field
Alt + F11	Open the VBA editor
F12	Save As
Shift + F12	Save
Ctrl + F12	Open
Alt + F8	Open the Macros dialog